

Build task: Expense Claims

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Duration: 48 hrs since this reached you over email.

The situation

Staff at a company spend their own money on travel, meals, supplies and taxis, then claim it back. They keep the receipt, file a claim, a manager signs it off, and finance pays it out at the end of the month.

Every company has a version of this and most of them are painful, because filing a claim takes longer than the coffee cost.

Build a working version of this.

Who uses it

- **Staff member** - files claims, watches what is still unpaid
- **Manager** - reviews the claims of their team and signs them off
- **Finance** - pays out and watches the monthly spend

What it needs to handle

Read these as things the business actually deals with, and decide for yourself what the software should do about each.

- Managers spend money too, so managers file claims as well. A manager must not be able to sign off their own claim. A claim that has been paid is finished and should not go backwards.
- People send the same receipt twice. Sometimes the same day, sometimes three weeks later, sometimes typed slightly differently the second time. Finance has paid twice before and wants that to stop.
- At the end of the month finance asks: who spent what, under which category, and who has gone over their limit.
- Nobody wants to fill in six fields for a 200 rupee auto ride. They paste in whatever is written on the receipt. Your system should turn that into a claim and show it back before it goes to the manager. They will correct it sometimes.

Your data

We are not giving you any. Create it yourself.

It should read like real receipts and real people, not `test1` and `test2`. Include receipts written badly, the same receipt filed twice in slightly different words, and somebody who is close to their monthly limit.

What to send us

Two things.

1. A link to a public GitHub repository. Its README should cover:

- how to run it
- the decisions and assumptions you made, especially anything we did not tell you
- which AI tools you used and where
- what you would do next if you had another week

2. A short video of you, on camera, face visible, 3 to 5 minutes, walking us through how you approached the problem, what gave you trouble, and what you referred to along the way. An unlisted YouTube link, a Drive link or a Loom link is fine.

We prefer a deployed URL or app we can open ourselves over something we have to run locally.

Notes

- Any language, any framework, any database. Your choice.
- AI tools are fine. Tell us which ones you used.
- We encourage you to lean on free tiers, and to plug in whatever providers and services save you time.
- If something needs a payment, emulate it. Payment gateway integration is not required.
- Taking more kinds of input than typed text, a photo or a screenshot as well, is a plus.